



2026

#HELishSummit

The AI Storage Challenge

How to Make More Content Available to Copilot While Keeping SharePoint Under Control

Adrian Ritter – glueckkanja AG

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Agenda

Lift & shift brings ROT
Copilot doesn't answer from what you pay for
The iceberg below the waterline
Automatic means no limit
A metadata edit costs a full copy
Relevance off, compliance on
Reduce, govern, archive – buy last

99 %

of the tenant storage quota is used

236 GB free

of 21,484 GB total quota

RealmJoin - SharePoint Online Storage Alert

Delete Archive Report Move to Reply Reply all Forward Chat Share to Teams Zoom

RealmJoin - SharePoint Online Storage Alert

RR RealmJoin Reports
To: Marco Scheel

Sun 2026-09-13 19:15

RI RealmJoin
Insights on Demand

SharePoint Online Tenant Storage Alert

Tenant: glueckkanja

Alert Reasons

- Free tenant storage (236 GB) is below the configured low-storage limit (0.29 GB).

Storage Summary

- Total Quota: 23484 GB
- Used: 23248 MB (99%)
- Free: 236 GB

High level view – SharePoint + Copilot

Buying more storage fixes the mail. It does not fix what Copilot has to read.

Maximize Relevance

Clean, classified,
current documents
Permission-trimmed
retrieval

Minimize Cost

Trim version bloat,
archive cold data
Buy storage only as
last resort

Stay Compliant

Retention and
sensitivity labels
eDiscovery across
all states

Relevance first, cost second – and always inside the compliance guardrails.

Lift & Shift Brings ROT

Redundant

Duplicates and copies
across shares and sites

Obsolete

Superseded documents
nobody opened in years

Trivial

Drafts, temp files and
personal clutter

**Lift & shift moves ROT into SharePoint – and you pay twice:
in storage bills and in Copilot answer quality.**

Two cloud targets – and a bridge



Content people work on together
and that Copilot should read



Data with no SharePoint benefit,
or read-only archives



Bridge, not a target: maps SharePoint as a drive letter when an application
insists on a path

**Scope starts with the applications, not the files – pick the target
per workload instead of moving everything into SharePoint.**

What to decide before the first file moves

1	Scope	Age-based cutoff – archive instead of migrate
2	Deduplicate	Hash report, then one rule – no built-in feature
3	Limit Migrated Versions	Cap at migration, trim the rest in place
4	Label & Govern	Library defaults plus auto-labeling
5	Validate	Reconciliation report plus sampling, then decommission

Done means scoped, deduplicated, collapsed, governed and reconciled – not just copied.

Stored content to grounding

Everything in the tenant all sites, versions, archives

Every byte you pay for

In the search index crawled and vectorized

Falls out here:
archived sites, unindexed content

Permissioned for the user
trimmed to actual access

Falls out here:
anything the user cannot open

Grounding the answer

What Copilot
actually answers with

You pay for the top bar. Copilot answers from the bottom one.

[Source: Microsoft Learn – Semantic index for Copilot](#)

SharePoint Storage Fundamentals

File Content

Documents, decks, media – the visible tip



Below the waterline – what quietly fills the tenant

Version History

Every version is
a full copy

Recycle Bin

93 days total,
stage one counts

Preservation Hold

Purview retention
holds copies

Sources: [Version storage](#) | [Data deletion & recycle bin](#) | [Retention for SharePoint](#)

Automatic quota means no limit ...and no alert

Tenant Pool

1 TB + 10 GB per licensed user
Shared across all site collections
Extra storage at \$0.20/GB/month
Hard ceiling, cannot be exceeded
Monitored in SharePoint Admin Center

Site Quotas

Admin-configurable per site collection
Automatic mode = no per-site cap
Manual mode required for storage alerts
Alert threshold set as % of manual quota
Unmanaged sites silently consume pool

Settings to gain control – Central Admin

Site storage limits

Share storage among all sites, [Learn more about managing storage](#)

☐ Automatic
Let sites use as much of your storage as possible

☒ Manual
Set specific limits for each site

Site creation

Select settings for new sites. [Learn more about managing site creation](#)

☐ Users can create SharePoint sites
Control whether users can create sites from SharePoint, OneDrive, the PnP PowerShell cmdlet, and the REST API. This setting doesn't affect whether users can create teams or Microsoft 365 groups and their connected sites.

Create team sites under
`https://c4a8alzoc.sharepoint.com`

Default time zone

Default storage limit for new sites

Set up your website

Give your website a name.

Website name *

✔ The site name is available.

Website description

Group Email Address *

✔ The group alias is available.

Website address *

✔ The site address is available.

Set language and other options

Confidentiality ⓘ

Privacy settings

Select language

Settings to gain control – Site Collection

Edit storage limit

The actual storage available for this site depends on the available storage for your organization.

[Learn more about managing site storage limits](#)

Maximum storage for this site *

10 GB

Enter a value from 1 through 25600.

☒ Allow notifications

Email owners when this much of the storage limit is used: *

85 %

Set a limit per site, not just the tenant limit

Without a site quota every site grows into the tenant pool

Notify at 85 %

The warning reaches the site owners while there is still time to act

Limits create ownership

Storage becomes a team decision instead of a central surprise

Quota plus notification turns storage growth into a routine, not a surprise.

Version History and Storage

500 MB

consumed by one 1 MB file
with 500 versions

Each version is a full copy
New libraries: automatic limits by default

Example from assessed environments:
3-5x more versions than files
Most organizations have no version policy

**Version history is usually the largest hidden storage cost
in SharePoint.**

A Metadata Change Costs a Full Copy

Site Settings › Storage Metrics ⓘ

Site Collection

9,00 GB free of 10,00 GB 

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Type	Name	Total Size↑	% of Parent	% of Site Quota	Last Modified
Dokumente		1 GB	99,87 %	10,00 %	13.09.2026 14:28
_catalogs		1,1 MB	0,11 %	0,01 %	13.09.2026 14:24
Websiteobjekte		60 KB	0,01 %	0,00 %	13.09.2026 14:25
Formularvorlagen		44,7 KB	0,00 %		
Websiteseiten		40 KB	0,00 %		
Formatbibliothek		28,3 KB	0,00 %		
Lists		28,1 KB	0,00 %		
Konvertierte Formulare		13,9 KB	0,00 %		
_cts		9,8 KB	0,00 %		
_private		< 1 KB	0,00 %		
_vti_pvt		< 1 KB	0,00 %		
images		< 1 KB	0,00 %		

Before: 1 GB used

Version history

Delete All Versions

No. ↓	Modified	Expiring In	Modified By	Size
3.0	13.09.2026 14:44	Never expires ⓘ	☐ Adrian Ritter	1024 MB
Title Testfile 1GB - HELish Summit				
2.0	13.09.2026 14:36	Never expires ⓘ	☐ Adrian Ritter	1024 MB
Title Testfile 1GB				
1.0	13.09.2026 14:28	Never expires ⓘ	☐ Adrian Ritter	1024 MB

Two title-only edits created versions 2.0 and 3.0 – 1024 MB each

Site Settings › Storage Metrics ⓘ

Site Collection

› Dokumente › Allgemein

5,98 GB free of 10,00 GB 

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Type	Name	Total Size↑	% of Parent	% of Site Quota	Last Modified	
	testfile.bin	3 GB	Not Available	30,00 %	13.09.2026 14:44	Version History
	Markdown Rules.md	211,6 KB	Not Available	0,00 %	13.09.2026 14:40	Version History

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1 GB to 3 GB

No byte of content changed. Only the Title column.

Three ways to trim versions – and the one thing that beats them all

1,2,3...

Version Limits

Cap major versions per library



Auto-Versioning

Keeps recent ones, thins older ones



Version Expiration

Deletes versions once they reach a set age

Manual control

you set it

it adapts

time decides

Automatic

Retention labels beat all three – labelled versions survive limits, thinning and expiration.

How Auto-Versioning Thins Version History

The Automatic setting keeps recent versions dense and older ones sparse – no admin input required



Version age

[Source: Microsoft Learn – Plan version storage on document libraries](#)

Trimming happens gradually – roughly 20 versions are removed each time the file is updated.

Automatic Versioning – Analyze first

Summary of Site Storage Usage	
Analyze the current state of version storage for this site and understand the version deletion distribution under the new settings	
Storage Metrics under current Version History Setting	
Total Site Version Storage Size (GBs)	1069,810136
Total Site Version (Count)	66664
Revised Storage Metrics under new Version History Setting	
Size of Versions Deleted Immediately (GBs)	845,8254844
Size of Versions set to be Deleted in the next 30 Days (GBs)	0
Size of Versions set to be Deleted in the next 30-180 Days (GBs)	0
Size of Versions set to be Deleted after 180 Days (GBs)	0
Count of Versions Deleted Immediately	47029
Count of Versions set to be Deleted in the next 30 Days	0
Count of Versions set to be Deleted in the next 30-180 Days	0
Count of Versions set to be Deleted after 180 Days	0

Get the picture before you trim

Version usage report on site, library or file level

Shows version count, age and storage consumed

Use editor information to identify automated processes, bulk updates and workflows that generate unusually high version volumes.

Simulate, then decide – trimmed versions are gone for good

```
New-SPOSiteFileVersionExpirationReportJob -Identity <SiteURL> -ReportUrl <ReportURL>
```

Sources: learn.microsoft.com/sharepoint/tutorial-generate-version-usage-report | learn.microsoft.com/sharepoint/version-storage-report-site

Retention and Preservation Hold



The Preservation Hold Library is hidden but real – monitor its size to avoid surprise consumption.

Storage Economics

Lower

list price for M365 Archive
vs. extra active storage

\$0.20

per GB/month beyond the
licensed allocation

\$0

Copilot value of
orphaned content

Version bloat is the largest hidden cost driver
You pay every month for storage you never clean up

Clean before you buy: every GB saved is \$0.20 a month recovered.

Microsoft 365 Archive

\$0.05

per GB/month
archive storage

Zero

archived files used for
Copilot grounding

75%

savings versus
active storage

Nothing is deleted – data stays in tenant
Archived data can be restored in full
Only the storage tier changes, not the data

eDiscovery and compliance preserved
Excluded from search and Copilot
Retention labels still enforced

No reactivation fee since March 2025 – only the 24-hour wait remains.

Site vs. File-Level Archive

Site-Level

Archives an entire site collection
All document libraries included
All-or-nothing granularity
Policy-driven for inactive sites
Reactivation up to 24 hours

File-Level

Archives individual files in a site
Selective, file by file
Rehydration on demand, not site-wide
Targets large, old files directly

Both levels: pay-as-you-go billing, retention and eDiscovery keep applying, content stays out of Copilot.

Out of Copilot, still in compliance

Capability	Active	Archived
Search and Copilot	Yes	No
eDiscovery and Retention	Yes	Yes
User access	Yes	No

Relevance: OFF

no search, no Copilot, no user access

Compliance: ON

retention, labels and eDiscovery keep working

Archive separates relevance from retention – the cleanest boundary available.

Reduce, Govern, Archive – buy storage last

1 REDUCE

Delete duplicates,
trim versions,
remove stale
content

2 GOVERN

Content types,
sensitivity and
retention labels

3 ARCHIVE

Silent to Copilot,
still available
for compliance

4 BUY

Only after
reducing,
governing and
archiving

Every GB you clean up saves money and makes Copilot better – the only lever that works in both directions.

Questions?

Your Session Feedback



The AI Storage Challenge



Kiitos!

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